



DAHLA MEMBER NEWSLETTER

Durango Area Hospitality & Lodgers Association

September
2026

Dear DAHLA Members,

September brings four straight weekends of festivals and events to Durango — good news for occupancy, but worth planning staffing and inventory around early. Here's what's on the calendar this month, plus a look ahead to October through December.

September at a Glance

SEPT 3–6

Four Corners Motorcycle Rally

La Plata County Fairgrounds & Durango Harley-Davidson

Labor Day weekend draws riders from across the region for daily events, workshops, and music. Expect strong weekend occupancy.

SEPT 4

True Western Roundup (Iron Horse Rodeo)

La Plata County Fairgrounds

A one-night western rodeo experience paired with the motorcycle rally crowd already in town.

SEPT 11

Durango Devo Film Fest

Chapman Hill

The 8th annual cycling and outdoor-adventure short film festival draws the local and regional biking community.

SEPT 12

Lake Nighthorse Triathlon

Lake Nighthorse

Athletes and their families converge for a full swim-bike-run event — a solid draw for weekend visitors.

SEPT 17

Chocolate Fantasia

La Plata County Fairgrounds & Event Center

A 30th-anniversary community fundraiser benefiting Volunteers of America Colorado's shelter programs.

SEPT 17

Mesa Verde Entrance Fee-Free Day

Mesa Verde National Park

One of the park's periodic fee waivers — a good heads-up for front desks fielding Mesa Verde questions this week.

SEPT 18

Autumn Gallery Walk

Downtown Durango & the Smiley Building

Twelve downtown galleries open their doors from 5–8 p.m. with art, music, and refreshments.

SEPT 19

Purgatory Oktoberfest

Purgatory Resort

Seasonal brews and German-inspired food kick off fall on the mountain.

SEPT 19–20

Autumn Arts Festival

2nd Avenue, Downtown Durango

Nearly 100 artist booths for the 32nd annual fine art and craft festival benefiting the Durango Arts Center — one of the bigger weekend draws of the month.

SEPT 24–27

San Juan Songwriters Festival

Venues throughout Downtown Durango

More than 20 songwriters perform in intimate "listening room" venues, supporting youth music education through iAM MUSIC.

SEPT 26–27

Oktoberfest at Buckley Park & WholeExpo

Buckley Park / La Plata County Fairgrounds

A two-day Oktoberfest benefiting the Durango Farmers Market runs downtown, while WholeExpo brings its annual holistic and wellness showcase to the fairgrounds — two events, two different crowds, same weekend.

SEPT 30 – OCT 4

Durango Cowboy Gathering Begins

Venues across Durango, including the Doubletree and Strater

The 36th annual Cowboy Gathering kicks off, running through the first weekend of October and closing with the popular parade and chuckwagon breakfast. Guests are already booking ahead — good to flag availability now.

Weekly & ongoing: Durango Farmers Market (Saturdays, TBK Bank lot, through Oct 31) and First Fridays downtown art walk continue throughout the month.

Reminder: Don't forget the upcoming Visit Durango & Tourism Advisory Commission Working Group sessions on Thursday, August 27 — a chance for the lodging community to weigh in directly on marketing, metrics, and destination management. See the DAHLA Events & Meetings page at durangelodging.org/events/ for full details and RSVP information.

Looking Ahead: October – December

October

OCT 16–18

Devo Days Bike Festival

Purgatory Resort

OCT 16–18

Animas Valley Balloon Rally

Downtown & Animas Valley

OCT 23–31

The Rocky Horror Show

Durango Arts Center

OCT 27

Mesa Verde Fee-Free Day

Mesa Verde National Park

OCT 29

Halloween Bike Parade & Powerhouse Party

Animas River Trail

OCT 31

Children's Halloween Trick-or-Treat & Carnival

Downtown Durango

November

NOV 11

Mesa Verde Fee-Free Day

Mesa Verde National Park

NOV 20 – JAN 2

The Polar Express Train

Durango & Silverton Narrow Gauge Railroad

NOV 21

Harvest Market

TBK Bank Parking Lot

NOV 26

Turkey Trot

Fort Lewis College

December

DEC 4–6

Holiday Arts & Crafts Festival

La Plata County Fairgrounds

DEC 12

Holiday Farmer's Market

La Plata County Fairgrounds

ONGOING

The Polar Express Train continues

Durango & Silverton Narrow Gauge Railroad

As always, thank you for everything you do to welcome Durango's visitors. Questions about this newsletter or ideas for future issues? Reach us at info@durangolodging.org.

— The DAHLA Board